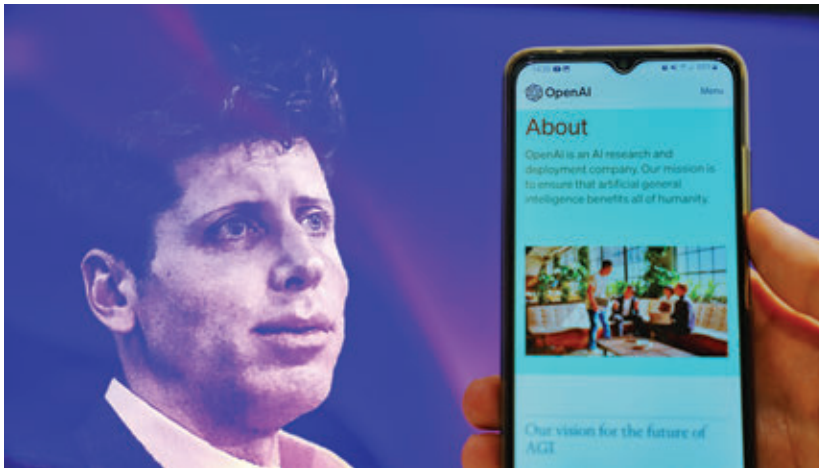




Altman's approach to AI ethics is both cautious and proactive. He has acknowledged the potential for AI technologies to be misused by bad actors, particularly in areas like surveillance, autonomous weaponry, and disinformation.

ensuring that AI would be developed safely and broadly benefit humanity. The organisation's non-profit roots were crucial in establishing its credibility in the early days, especially as concerns over AI safety and ethics were growing.

However, Altman and OpenAI soon realised that advancing AI research to the level of AGI required massive computational resources, talent, and financial investment. These requirements were far beyond what could be supported by a non-profit organisation. In 2019, Altman made the controversial decision to transition OpenAI into a "capped-profit" entity—a hybrid model that allowed for-profit investment while limiting returns for investors. The model was designed to align incentives with OpenAI's mission to prioritise societal benefit over pure profit.

This structural change was met with mixed reactions. Some saw it as a betrayal of OpenAI's original mis-

sion, arguing that the move towards commercialisation could compromise its commitment to ethical AI development. Others viewed it as a pragmatic approach to ensure the organisation had the necessary resources to stay competitive in an increasingly

crowded and well-funded AI landscape. Altman navigated this transition deftly, securing a landmark partnership with Microsoft that has since proven to be crucial for OpenAI's success.

Microsoft's multi-billion-dollar investment in OpenAI provided the financial fuel for projects like ChatGPT and the resources to scale OpenAI's cutting-edge research. The partnership also allowed OpenAI to integrate its AI technologies into widely-used software like Microsoft Office and Azure Cloud. Through this, Altman has positioned OpenAI as a global leader in the commercial AI space while maintaining its core mission. By embedding its AI tools into Microsoft's vast ecosystem, OpenAI has been able to democratise access to advanced AI technologies, enabling businesses and individuals to leverage AI for a wide range of applications.

This strategic pivot has not only cemented OpenAI's place at the forefront of AI research but also highlighted Altman's ability to balance innovation with financial pragmatism. The capped-profit model, while not without its critics, allowed OpenAI to tap into the vast resources of the private sector without entirely abandoning its ethical goals.

Ethical dilemmas and public flak

As OpenAI has grown, so too have the ethical dilemmas it faces. Much like

